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The State of Digital Intelligence 2026

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Convergence – The Market as One Battlefield

An independent ProductBeacon market briefing on the government & national-security intelligence software market – lawful interception, OSINT/WEBINT, decision intelligence. The convergence synthesis; the sixth and final part, reading the five fronts as one market.

Disclosures. The author, Yohay Etsion, served as VP Product at Cognyte, which competes across several of the fronts synthesized here (its NEXYTE and LUMINAR platforms). This chapter is independent ProductBeacon research based **solely on publicly available material**; it reflects the author's personal analysis, not Cognyte's position. **This report does not constitute investment, legal, tax, or accounting advice.** No claim here should be relied upon as the basis for any investment decision. As of June 2026, the author holds no position in any named public security – directly or via a cybersecurity-sector ETF – and is not compensated by any named vendor.

On method. Every cross-front claim below is built only from each vendor's own public product pages, public filings, and dated named-outlet reporting – the same material the five front chapters cite. Where a vendor's public footprint does not support a claim, the claim is not made. Portfolio-breadth is measured strictly as *the number of the five practices a vendor's public product pages span*, never as an asserted "full suite." Capability is reported as *what a vendor publicly markets*, not as verified architecture, which cannot be confirmed from outside.

Key terms used in this chapter.

- **The five fronts.** National Agencies / SIGINT (mass-scale network collection); Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers (warrant-scoped lawful interception); Tactical Intelligence (field RF / device collection); Fusion / Decision Intelligence (the analytical layer); Open-Source Intelligence / WEBINT (open-source and web intelligence).
- **The collection-fusion stack** – the structural relationship between the fronts: National Agencies, Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers, Tactical Intelligence, and Open-Source Intelligence *produce* intelligence material; Fusion / Decision Intelligence *makes sense of it*. Fusion sits on top of the other four by construction.
- **Portfolio breadth** – here, a count of how many of the five practices a single vendor's *public product pages* span, each span anchored to a dated page. It is a measure of public positioning, not of an internally verified product suite.
- **AI-native / agentic positioning** – a vendor's *public marketing* of large-language-model-driven, autonomous, or "agentic" capability. Whether the underlying architecture is genuinely AI-native cannot be verified from public material; the term is used throughout as "markets itself as," not as an architectural finding.

C.1 Leading Briefing

Read the five fronts together and the government-intelligence software market resolves into a single battlefield with a clear shape. Four of the fronts are collection – strategic network collection (National Agencies), warrant-scoped interception (Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers), tactical field collection (Tactical Intelligence), and open-source / web collection (Open-Source Intelligence). The fifth, fusion (Fusion / Decision Intelligence), is not a collection silo at all; it is the analytical layer every other front feeds. That asymmetry is the master fact of the market: collection is fragmenting and commoditizing front by front, while the value migrates upward to the layer that resolves, links, and decides. The vendors winning the decade are the ones climbing toward that layer; the vendors being squeezed are the ones stuck in commoditizing collection beneath a free or sanctioned floor.

Across the fronts, four cross-market patterns recur with enough public evidence to name.

First, portfolio breadth concentrates unevenly – most vendors hold one practice, a cluster holds two, and exactly one spans the whole stack on public pages. A network-interception cluster – ClearTrail, Vehere, Trovicor – spans the two interception fronts (National Agencies mass collection plus Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers warrant-scoped lawful interception) on public pages. Palantir spans the analytical layer plus the feeds it ingests (graded in fusion, referenced

wherever it ingests SIGINT or OSINT feeds). And one vendor — Cognyte — carries graded public-page pillars across all five practices: collection in National Agencies (network-intelligence glossary), Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers (the NEXYTE-LEA “lawful interception ... data source” line), and Tactical Intelligence (border-protection “SIGINT, OSINT and VISINT”), fusion in Fusion / Decision Intelligence (NEXYTE), and OSINT in Open-Source Intelligence (LUMINAR).⁴⁸⁴⁹⁵⁰¹² That is the only full collection-to-fusion span on this report’s own grading of public pages. But that widest span is breadth of public positioning, assembled across separate pages, a SEC filing, and a registered trademark. It is *not* evidence of an integrated, verified five-front product suite. It is a span across the public-marketing stack, not an owned, unified product across it.

Second, the AI-native repositioning is concentrated in the two analytical fronts. “Agentic” is now the lead homepage word in fusion and OSINT — Palantir’s AIP, Cognyte’s “agentic AI-based decision flows,” Dataminr’s “built with agentic and predictive AI at its core,” Babel Street’s “Governed AI agents... in minutes, not days,” Strider’s “One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence.”⁴⁵⁶⁷⁸ In SIGINT, AI is defensive — encrypted-traffic intelligence to recover visibility lost to TLS 1.3 and QUIC.⁹ In lawful interception and tactical, the front is not AI-led at all; it is led by standards and by encryption-and-hardware physics.

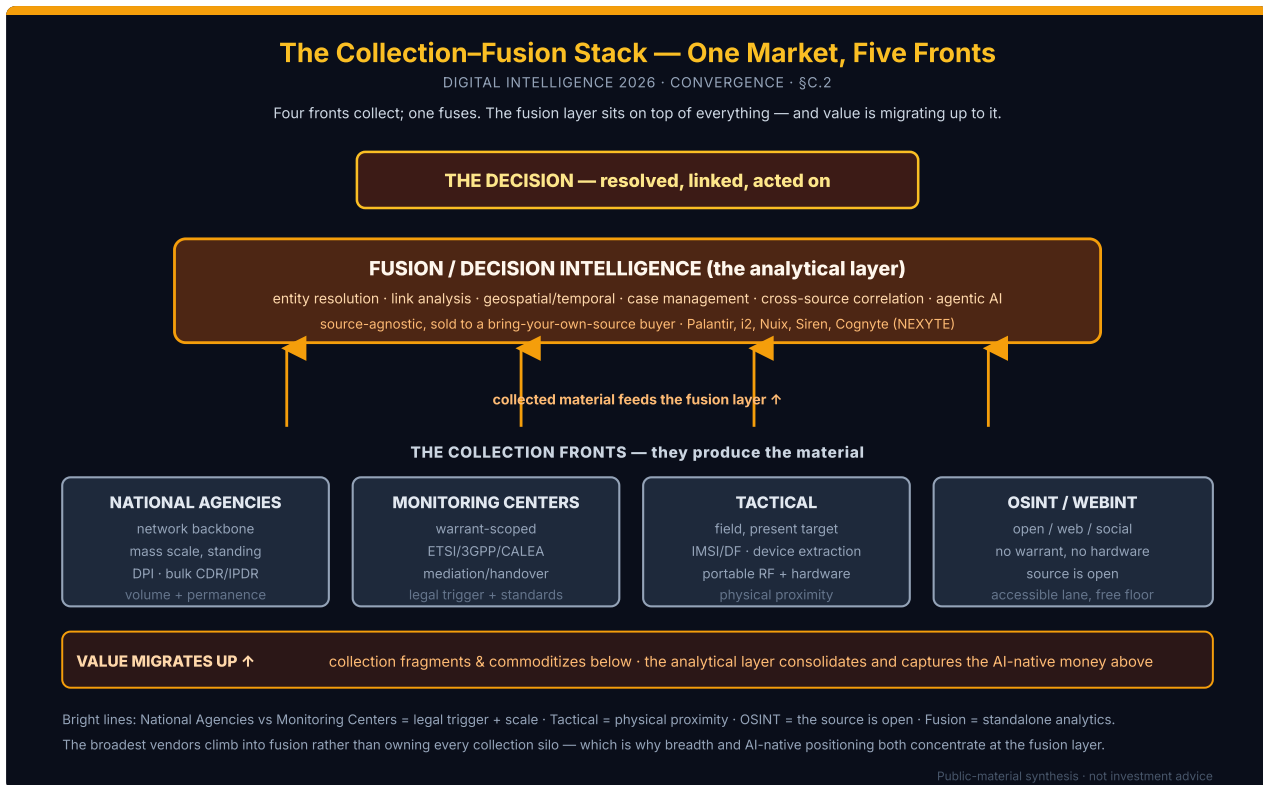
Third, consolidation is running on two distinct engines. One is strategic acquirers absorbing the OSINT layer into adjacent platforms, with Mastercard’s \$2.65B purchase of Recorded Future the signature deal.¹⁰ The other is private equity rolling up the collection and interception layer (Thoma Bravo’s ~C\$1.8B take-private of Magnet/Grayshift; Mill Point’s acquisition of SS8).¹¹¹²

Fourth, the fronts are not equally in play — OSINT and fusion are the contested, fast-moving, AI-native battlegrounds; lawful interception is the most defended and least disrupted; SIGINT faces an existential technology shift in encryption; tactical is bifurcating as device forensics rises and classic RF interception declines.

The strategic reading is the same for any operator in this market, whether incumbent prime, specialist collector, OSINT pure-play, or new entrant: the floor is rising under collection and the ceiling is rising over fusion. The defensible positions in 2026 are three. The analytical layer, if you can pass accreditation and prove AI actually compresses time-to-decision. The standards-gated interception niche, if you can afford the 5G conformance bar. And government-anchored mission depth, if the free OSINT floor cannot follow you up-stack. The exposed positions are commodity open-web collection, content-interception value propositions that encryption is hollowing out, and any vendor whose breadth is asserted rather than visible on a public page.

C.2 The Market Reassembled — One Stack, Five Fronts

The five fronts are usually sold, bought, and analyzed separately, and the front chapters treat them that way for good reason: each has its own buyer, its own barrier, and its own competitive logic. But the convergence view requires seeing how they stack. Four of the five fronts collect; one fuses.



The collection fronts produce material along different axes. National Agencies collects at the network backbone, at mass scale, as standing infrastructure. Its defining property is volume and permanence, and its public anchors are vendor pages for “lawful interception,” “network intelligence,” and DPI engines.⁹¹³ Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers collects the same kind of traffic but under a fundamentally different trigger: a per-target warrant, mediated through standards-certified handover interfaces (ETSI TS 102 232; 3GPP TS 33.127/128; US CALEA / J-STD-025).¹⁴ Tactical Intelligence collects in the field, against a present target, with portable RF and device hardware — IMSI catchers, direction-finding, device extraction.¹⁵¹⁶ Open-Source Intelligence collects from openly available, web, social, and dark-web sources, with no privileged access, no warrant, and no field hardware.¹⁷ These four are technically distinct and, critically for this report, *non-overlapping by buyer and trigger*. The bright line between National Agencies and Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers is the legal trigger and scale, not the technology; the bright line around Tactical Intelligence is physical proximity; the bright line around Open-Source Intelligence is that the source is open.

Fusion sits on top of all four. Fusion / Decision Intelligence is the analytical layer that ingests already-collected data and resolves it into entities, maps relationships, places them in space and time, and turns the result into a decision — sold standalone to a bring-your-own-source buyer.¹⁸ This is why fusion is the front where breadth and AI-native positioning both concentrate: a fusion platform by construction touches every collection front’s output, so the vendors that want to span the market climb into fusion rather than try to own every collection silo.

Cognyte’s national-security NEXYTE page makes the stack explicit in a vendor’s own words. It describes intelligence generated “by unifying agencies’ data sources, including lawful interception, digital forensics, open sources and government databases” — lawful interception and forensics appearing *on that page* as input sources the fusion platform consumes, which is what anchors Cognyte’s fusion grade in Fusion / Decision Intelligence.³ Separately, on other dated public surfaces, Cognyte carries graded collection pillars in their own right — a network-intelligence/SIGINT glossary (National Agencies), a border-protection page citing “SIGINT, OSINT and VISINT” sources (Tactical Intelligence), and a registered VANTAGE trademark and SEC filing describing “interception, collection, monitoring” (corroborating National Agencies / Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers).⁴⁸⁵⁰ The two surfaces coexist: the fusion page frames collection as analytics input, while the glossary, border-protection page, filing, and mark carry the collection positioning directly. The public record does not show a current standalone monitoring-centre product page; the warrant-scoped LI grade rests on the NEXYTE-LEA “data source” line and the

filing/trademark lineage, not on a marketed standalone collection product. Palantir's platform is described in the same architectural register, as "a commercially-available, AI-ready operating system that improves and accelerates decisions for operators across roles and all domains."¹⁹

The consequence of the stack is what I read as the single most important structural fact in the convergence: **value is migrating up**. Collection is doing three things at once. It is fragmenting (the National Agencies front's seven-plus specialists, the Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers' private long tail, Tactical Intelligence's two-issuer-plus-tail, Open-Source Intelligence's sixteen-plus contenders). It is commoditizing (the open-source free floor; encryption hollowing National Agencies' and Tactical Intelligence's content yield). And in places it is being sanctioned out of legitimacy (the surveillance cohort). Fusion, by contrast, is consolidating at the top, defended by accreditation, and is where the AI-native money is being raised and spent. Every cross-front pattern below is, at root, a consequence of that upward migration.

C.3 Portfolio Breadth — Who Actually Spans the Market

The most-asked question about this market is which vendor "does everything." The clean-room-safe way to answer it is not to repeat any vendor's marketing claim of a complete suite. Instead, *count public spans*: for each vendor, how many of the five practices does its own public product material actually cover, each span anchored to a dated page? Counted that way, breadth is real but uneven, and it concentrates in two distinct shapes.

Portfolio Breadth — Who Spans the Market (public pages only)					
DIGITAL INTELLIGENCE 2026 · CONVERGENCE · §C.3 · PATTERN CLAIM 1					
The broadest spans are anchored at fusion — breadth is a fusion position, not a five-front collection suite					
	National Agencies	Monitoring Centers	Tactical	Fusion	OSINT
Cognyte	graded	graded	graded	NEXYTE	LUMINAR
Palantir	ref			AIP / Gotham	ref
ClearTrail	graded	graded			
Vehere	graded	graded			
Trovicor	graded	graded			
Septier		LI mediation	IMSI catcher		
BAE Systems	graded			divested '22	
i2 Group				graded	
Babel Street					graded

☒ graded — public positioning pillar in this practice
 ☐ referenced — public mention/input, not graded
 ☐ no public footprint

FALSIFIABLE TEST — PATTERN CLAIM 1: BREADTH IS A FUSION POSITION, NOT A SUITE

The broadest public footprints in this market are not the ones owning the most collection silos; they are anchored at the fusion layer, which by construction spans every collection front's output. Cognyte carries the widest public span — the only vendor graded in all five practices, each on a distinct dated pillar — yet its breadth is still fusion-anchored: NEXYTE unifies the collection fronts as inputs. Palantir holds the same fusion-anchored breadth; the only multi-collection-front span (ClearTrail, Vehere, Trovicor across both interception fronts) shares DPI/mediation.

If H2 2026 a vendor publishes graded standalone pillars in 3+ practices — including a collection front beyond the interception pair — the reading weakens toward a genuine multi-front suite. If the broadest spans stay anchored at fusion, the claim holds.

Public product pages only · positioning, not verified architecture · not investment advice

The cross-front vendor ledger (public pages only).

Vendor	National Agencies · SIGINT	Monitoring Centers · LI	Tactical	Fusion	OSINT	Public span
Cognyte	graded (network-intelligence glossary) ⁴⁸	graded (NEXYTE-LEA "lawful interception ... data source") ⁴⁹	graded (border-protection "SIGINT, OSINT and VISINT") ⁵⁰	graded (NEXYTE) ¹	graded (LUMINAR) ²	All five practices graded on public pages – collection (National Agencies / Monitoring Centers / Tactical) + fusion (Fusion / Decision Intelligence) + OSINT (Open-Source Intelligence); the only full-stack public span on this report's own grading of public pages (breadth of public positioning, not a verified suite)
Palantir	referenced	—	—	graded (AIP/Gotham/Foundry) ¹⁹	referenced	Fusion graded; ingests SIGINT/OSINT feeds
ClearTrail	graded ¹³	graded ²⁰	(claims "tactical" monitoring) ¹³	—	—	Both interception fronts (National Agencies + Monitoring Centers)
Vehere	graded ²¹	graded ²²	—	—	—	Both interception fronts (National Agencies + Monitoring Centers)
Trovicor	graded ²³	graded ²⁴	—	—	—	Both interception fronts (National Agencies + Monitoring Centers)

Vendor	National Agencies · SIGINT	Monitoring Centers · LI	Tactical	Fusion	OSINT	Public span
Septier	—	graded (LI mediation) ²⁵	graded (IMSI catcher) ²⁶	—	—	Interception + tactical (distinct products)
BAE Systems	graded (IntelligenceReveal) ²⁷	—	—	referenced (NetReveal divested 2022) ²⁸	—	SIGINT graded; fusion divested
i2 Group	—	—	—	graded (knowledge graph) ²⁹	—	Fusion only
Babel Street	—	—	—	—	graded (multilingual OSINT) ⁶	OSINT (PenLink-adjacent)

Cognyte is graded across all five practices on distinct dated public pillars, a different quoted line per front, never one pillar reused across fronts. The pillars are National Agencies on its network-intelligence/SIGINT glossary,⁴⁸ Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers on the NEXYTE-LEA “lawful interception ... data source” line,⁴⁹ Tactical Intelligence on the border-protection “SIGINT, OSINT and VISINT” line,⁵⁰ Fusion / Decision Intelligence on NEXYTE,¹ and Open-Source Intelligence on LUMINAR.² The span is breadth of public positioning measured across pages, not evidence of a verified integrated five-front product suite (see Pattern Claim 1).

Two shapes fall out of the ledger. **The first is the network-interception cluster.** ClearTrail, Vehere, and Trovicor each carry public pillars in both interception fronts. ClearTrail, for example, markets solutions that “enable the LEAs to perform MASS, TARGETED & TACTICAL Monitoring and Analysis across a variety of communication networks” (National Agencies). It also markets a separate ETSI-compliant lawful-interception product that “interfaces with the mediation device to acquire, decode, and reconstruct ETSI-compliant Voice and IP traffic over HI2 and HI3 interfaces” (Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers).¹³²⁰ These vendors span both interception fronts because the underlying technology (DPI, mediation) genuinely serves both the mass-collection and the warrant-scoped buyer. The span is real and public, and it is the closest thing in the study to a two-front collection suite.

The second shape is the full-stack public span, and it is where Cognyte sits. Cognyte is the only vendor in the study whose public material carries *graded* pillars in all five practices, each anchored to a distinct dated surface. Collection appears in National Agencies (its network-intelligence/SIGINT glossary), Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers (the NEXYTE-LEA page positioning “lawful interception ... digital forensics, open sources and government databases” as unified data sources), and Tactical Intelligence (its border-protection page “fusing together with SIGINT, OSINT and VISINT sources”). Fusion appears in Fusion / Decision Intelligence (NEXYTE — “Apply agentic AI-based decision flows”; “Fuse and analyze data across sources to resolve identities and uncover relations”). And OSINT appears in Open-Source Intelligence (LUMINAR — “AI-powered external threat intelligence solution ... with comprehensive visibility into their threat landscape”).⁴⁸⁴⁹⁵⁰¹² That is, on my reading of the public pages, the widest span in the report — the only full-stack public span on this report’s own grading of public pages, the only one that runs the full distance from collection to fusion.

It is essential to state precisely what that span is and is not. It is breadth of public positioning measured across pages, filings, and a registered trademark. It is **not** evidence of an integrated, verified five-front product suite. On Cognyte’s own surfaces the breadth assembles from separate places. The national-security NEXYTE page frames lawful interception and forensics as analytics *inputs* the fusion platform consumes (graded in Fusion / Decision Intelligence). The collection pillars are carried separately on the glossary (National Agencies) and the border-protection page (Tactical Intelligence), and corroborated by a SEC filing and a registered mark (National Agencies / Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers). It does not assemble from one unified suite page marketing all five as a single product. Palantir occupies a narrower, fusion-anchored breadth from the other direction — graded in fusion, referenced wherever its platform ingests SIGINT or OSINT feeds. That is the structural signature of the upward migration: vendors are broad *because they sit at or climb toward the fusion layer that touches everything*, not because they publish one verified product spanning every collection silo.

The rest of the cross-front ledger anchors single practices on its public pages, and surfacing those pillars is what makes the full-stack span distinctive by contrast. i2 Group markets “The knowledge graph solution at the forefront of intelligence analysis” — fusion only.²⁹ BAE Systems markets its IntelligenceReveal portfolio for “Communications Intelligence and Multi-Source Analysis” in SIGINT; it divested its NetReveal fusion line to SymphonyAI in 2022, so on public pages it now anchors SIGINT only.²⁷²⁸ Babel Street anchors OSINT, marketing “Governed AI agents on rights-cleared, mission-grade data to produce decision-ready intelligence in minutes, not days.”⁶ Septier spans the interception and tactical fronts with two genuinely distinct products: a lawful-interception mediation solution “for all telecom and data networks using any technology” (Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers) and an Identities Catcher “capturing up to 11 different identifiers for each cellular device” (Tactical Intelligence).²⁵²⁶ That is a real cross-front footprint, but two separate boxes rather than one platform. These are not breadth plays; they are the reminder that most of the market remains single-practice, which is exactly what makes Cognyte’s full-stack public span — and Palantir’s narrower fusion-anchored breadth — the exception worth naming.

Pattern Claim 1 — Breadth Is a Stack Position, Not a Verified Suite

One vendor — Cognyte — carries graded public-page pillars across all five practices: collection in National Agencies (network-intelligence/SIGINT glossary), Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers (the NEXYTE-LEA “lawful interception ... data source” line), and Tactical Intelligence (the border-protection “SIGINT, OSINT and VISINT” line); fusion in Fusion / Decision Intelligence (NEXYTE); and OSINT in Open-Source Intelligence (LUMINAR). On my reading of the public pages that is the only full collection-to-fusion span on this report’s own grading of public pages. But the widest span is **breadth of public positioning across pages, not evidence of an integrated, verified five-front product suite**. On Cognyte’s own pages the interception and forensic capabilities surface via a SEC filing, a registered trademark, and deeper product/glossary pages rather than a single unified suite page. Palantir holds a narrower, fusion-anchored breadth from the analytics-prime side (graded in fusion, referenced wherever its platform ingests SIGINT or OSINT feeds). The only multi-collection-front breadth among the rest (ClearTrail, Vehere, Trovicor across National Agencies and Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers) is confined to the two interception fronts that share DPI/mediation technology. The pattern, on my reading: the broadest public span is a position spanning the *marketing* stack, not proof of an owned, verified product across it.

Falsifiable test. Suppose that through H2 2026 a single vendor publishes an *integrated*, named, single-platform reference unifying three or more collection-and-fusion practices as one *verified* product, not a span of separate product pages, public filings, and trademarks. Then the “public-span-not-a-verified-suite” reading weakens toward a real integrated suite. If instead the broadest footprint stays a span of distinct public surfaces (separate pages, filings, marks) rather than one verified integrated platform, the claim holds. Primary signal: vendors’ own dated product pages, single-platform reference architectures, and investor materials; analyst reclassification.

C.4 The AI-Native Repositioning — Concentrated, Not Universal

“AI-native” and “agentic” are the words of 2026 across this market, but they are not distributed evenly. Read across the fronts, the agentic repositioning concentrates almost entirely in the two analytical fronts, is defensive in SIGINT, and is essentially absent — as a *leading* positioning — in lawful interception and tactical.

The AI-Native Repositioning — Concentrated, Not Universal

DIGITAL INTELLIGENCE 2026 · CONVERGENCE · §C.4 · PATTERN CLAIM 2

"Agentic" is the lead word in the two analytical fronts, defensive in SIGINT, and absent as a lead in interception and tactical

AGENTIC IS THE LEAD MESSAGE — the analytical fronts

AI sold as new capability that compresses time-to-decision · this is where the AI-native money is being raised and spent

FUSION

Palantir AIP — "embed LLMs and AI agents... automate decisions"
 Cognynte NEXYTE — "agentic AI-based decision flows"
 i2 — "i2 Insights" for assisted import & analysis

OSINT

Dataminr — "built with agentic and predictive AI at its core"
 Babel Street — "Governed AI agents... in minutes, not days"
 Strider — "One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence"

AI IS DEFENSIVE — SIGINT / National Agencies

AI sold as the mechanism of survival against encryption erosion (TLS 1.3 / ECH / QUIC), not as a new capability

ipoque ETI — "combines improved DPI with AI and ML... to restore visibility into encrypted network traffic" ·

ClearTrail — "leveraging artificial intelligence models on big data" · Vehere — "AI-powered Network Intelligence"

NOT AI-LED — lawful interception & tactical

Lawful interception: led by standards conformance & "immutable audit trails"; adapts to 5G through 3GPP-defined functions, not AI.

Tactical: AI used as acceleration only — Cellebrite "AI-powered decoding," MSAB GPU brute-force. The disruptor is encryption and the lab-to-field collapse; compute is the enabler, not the disruptive force.

FALSIFIABLE TEST — PATTERN CLAIM 2: THE AGENTIC LINE HAS NOT YET BEEN DRAWN

As of mid-2026 no fusion or OSINT vendor has published a named government/enterprise reference attributing a decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action (vs analyst-assisted search). The repositioning is real as positioning; unproven as capability.

If by Q4 2026 a vendor publishes a named-outcome agentic reference (or an independent time-to-insight benchmark) and rivals do not → AI-native separates into a real differentiator. If "agentic" stays uniform with no named win → it is table stakes.

"Markets itself as," not verified architecture · public pages only · not investment advice

In fusion and OSINT, agentic is the lead message. In fusion, Palantir markets AIP as embedding "large language models (LLMs) and AI agents directly into the systems your teams use every day, enabling them to automate decisions, analyze enormous datasets, and execute tasks," and Cognynte's NEXYTE markets "agentic AI-based decision flows."⁴⁵ In OSINT, the agentic language is even denser: Dataminr describes its platform as "built with agentic and predictive AI at its core," Babel Street markets "Governed AI agents on rights-cleared, mission-grade data to produce decision-ready intelligence in minutes, not days," and Strider leads with "One Platform, Powered by Agentic Intelligence."⁶⁷⁸ The money follows the message: Dataminr's \$100M Fortress financing in April 2025 was explicitly raised "to accelerate gen AI and agentic AI product innovation."³⁰ These are the named, public, AI-native entrants the convergence claim rests on. That nameability is exactly the test the report set for keeping AI-native as a central claim rather than demoting it to a watchlist item: the entrants can be named from their own public pages.

In SIGINT, AI is defensive, not offensive. The National Agencies vendors market AI/ML primarily to *recover* capability that encryption is taking away: ipoque's encrypted-traffic intelligence "combines improved DPI with artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) techniques to restore visibility into encrypted network traffic," and ClearTrail and Vehere market AI-on-big-data and "AI-powered Network Intelligence."⁹¹³²¹ The framing is telling. In fusion and OSINT, AI is sold as a *new* capability that compresses time-to-decision. In SIGINT, AI is sold as the *mechanism of survival* against the TLS 1.3 / ECH / QUIC erosion of classic passive content inspection.

In lawful interception and tactical, the front is not AI-led. The Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers' graded contenders' warrant-scoped pages carry no "AI-native" or "agentic" framing. The front differentiates on standards conformance and on "immutable audit trails," and adapts to 5G through 3GPP-defined functions, not through AI.¹⁴ Tactical Intelligence's vendors market AI as *acceleration* — Cellebrite's "AI-powered decoding," MSAB's GPU-accelerated brute-force moving extraction "to the field" — not as autonomous agentic systems.¹⁵¹⁶ The disruptive force in tactical is encryption and the lab-to-field collapse, with compute as the enabler, not AI as the disruptor.

Pattern Claim 2 — The Agentic Line Has Not Yet Been Drawn

Across fusion and OSINT, “agentic” has become uniform marketing language, but as of mid-2026 no vendor has published a *named* government or enterprise reference attributing a specific decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action, as distinct from analyst-assisted search. The repositioning is real as positioning; it is unproven as differentiated capability.

Falsifiable test. Suppose that by Q4 2026 one or more vendors in fusion or OSINT publish named-customer references — or independent time-to-insight benchmarks — that attribute a decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action, and competitors do not. In that case the agentic claims begin separating into a real differentiator, and AI-native becomes a genuine competitive axis. If “agentic” stays uniform across all of them through Q4 2026 with no named-outcome win, the layer is positioning, not capability, and should be read as table stakes rather than separation. Primary signal: vendor press releases and government reference-win coverage (Dataminr, Babel Street, Strider, Cognyte, Palantir newsrooms); the architecture itself remains unverifiable from outside.

C.5 Where the Pressure Is Highest — The Multi-Market Threat Ranking

Not all five fronts are equally in play. Rank them by the intensity of competitive and structural pressure — growth, entry barrier, concentration, deal tempo, and exposure to the AI-native and encryption shifts — and a clear order emerges. That order is itself a strategic finding: the pressure is highest exactly where the value is migrating (the analytical layer) and where the floor is rising fastest (open-source collection), and lowest where standards still hold the line (lawful interception).

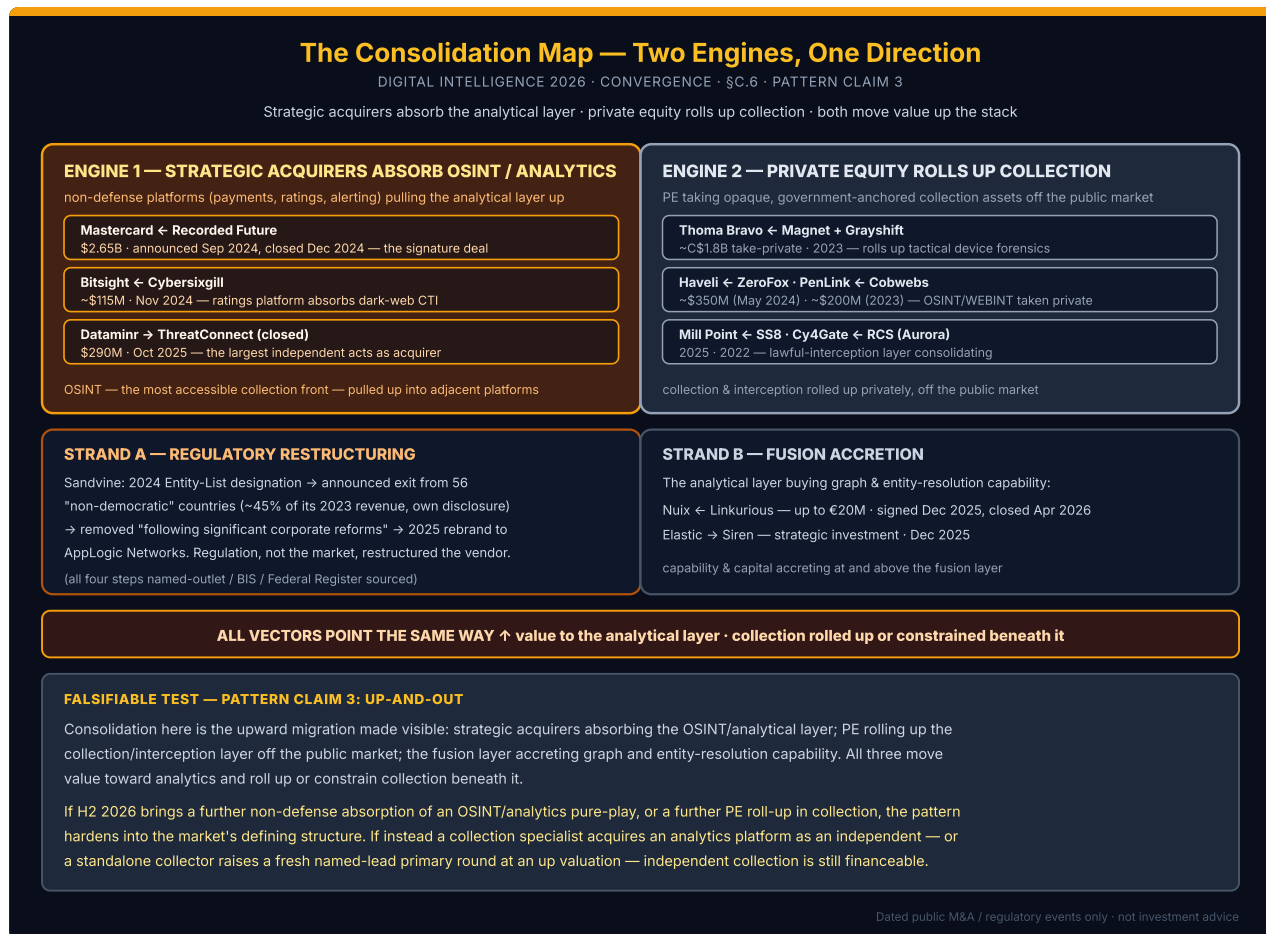
Where the Pressure Is Highest — Multi-Market Threat Ranking					
DIGITAL INTELLIGENCE 2026 · CONVERGENCE · §C.5					
Pressure is highest where value is migrating (fusion) and where the floor is rising fastest (OSINT) — lowest where standards hold the line					
	GROWTH	ENTRY BARRIER	CONCENTRATION	AI / TECH-SHIFT	PRESSURE
1 OSINT	High 15.6–27%+	Low–moderate	Fragmented, rolling up	Highest	●●●●●
Most contested · fastest deal tempo · AI-native arms race · commodity floor rising from below Why #1: consolidation + AI-native + commoditization squeeze all converge here, and the entry barrier is the lowest					
2 Fusion	High 15.4–19.1%	High (accreditation)	Concentrated at top	High	●●●●○
Highest-value layer & AI-native battleground — but accreditation-defended (value capture concentrates at the top) Why #2: the agentic contest and the value are here, but FedRAMP/IL6 accreditation slows entry and Palantir holds gravity					
3 National Agencies	Split 5–6% / 19–24%	High (export control)	Specialists + primes	High (encryption)	●●●○○
Faces a structural technology shift — encryption hollowing content inspection, forcing the front toward metadata/ETI Why #3: the encryption-erosion threat is existential but slow-moving and export-control-gated					
4 Tactical	Forensics 12–16%	High (export+reputation)	2 issuers + private tail	Moderate	●●○○○
A front splitting in two — device forensics rising, classic RF interception declining Why #4: bifurcating; encryption is the force and the surveillance reckoning narrows the legitimate set					
5 Monitoring Centers	High but opaque 18–30%	Highest (LI certification)	Fragmenting → PE	Low (standards-led)	●○○○○
The most defended and least disrupted front — the standards moat holds, adaptation runs through 3GPP, not AI Why #5: last on pressure because first on defensibility; the pressure that exists is PE roll-up, not displacement					
Ranking is of competitive/structural pressure — where the ground is moving fastest — not of market size or profitability. Growth = public CAGRs cited to publishers (ranges, never averaged). Pressure score is the author's composite read of the four columns; it is an opinion-labeled synthesis, not a measured index.					
Public-material synthesis · opinion-labeled · not investment advice					

Rank	Front	Growth (public CAGRs)	Entry barrier	Concentration	AI / tech-shift exposure	Why it ranks here
1	Open-Source Intelligence	High (15.6%–27%+) ³¹	Low–moderate (COTS on GSA/Carahsoft) ¹⁷	Fragmented, rolling up fast (3 exits in 18 mo) ¹⁰³⁷³⁹	Highest (agentic battleground + free-floor squeeze)	Most contested front: fastest deal tempo, lowest barrier, AI-native arms race, commodity floor rising from below
2	Fusion / Decision Intelligence	High (15.4%–19.1%) ³²	High (FedRAMP High / DoD IL6 accreditation) ¹⁹	Concentrated at top (Palantir gravity) ¹⁹	High (agentic over resolved graphs)	Highest-value layer and AI-native battleground, but accreditation-defended – value capture concentrates at the top
3	National Agencies / SIGINT	Split: SIGINT mature (5%–6%); DPI/network-intel high (19%–24%) ³³	High (export control: Wassenaar, EU 2021/821, US EAR) ³⁴	Fragmented specialists + prime tier	High (encrypted-traffic erosion is existential)	Faces a structural technology shift – encryption hollowing content inspection, forcing the whole front toward metadata/ETI
4	Tactical Intelligence	Bifurcated: forensics 12%–16%; RF interception flat 5%–10% ³⁵	High (export control + reputational/litigation overhang)	Two public issuers + private tail ¹⁶	Moderate (encryption is the force; compute the enabler)	A front splitting in two – device forensics rising, classic RF interception declining; the surveillance reckoning narrows the legitimate set
5	Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers	High near-term but opaque (18%–30%) ³⁶	Highest (LI standards-conformance certification) ¹⁴	Fragmenting toward PE roll-up ¹²	Low (standards-led, not AI-led)	The most defended and least disrupted front – the standards moat holds, adaptation runs through 3GPP, not AI; pressure is roll-up, not displacement

The ranking is not a claim about which front is *largest* or most *profitable* – it is a claim about where the competitive ground is moving fastest. OSINT and fusion top the list because that is where the AI-native repositioning, the M&A tempo, and (for OSINT) the commoditization squeeze all converge. SIGINT ranks third on a technology-shift threat that is existential but slow-moving and export-control-gated. Tactical ranks fourth as a bifurcating front. Lawful interception ranks last on *pressure* precisely because it is first on *defensibility*: the standards-conformance barrier is the hardest in the study, and the front adapts to 5G inside the standards rather than being displaced from outside. ¹⁴

C.6 The Consolidation Map — Two Engines, One Direction

Cross-front dealmaking is the loudest signal of 2026, and read across the fronts it runs on two distinct engines pulling in the same direction — value up, collection rolled up or absorbed — with a regulatory-restructuring strand and a fusion-accretion strand running alongside.



Engine one: strategic acquirers absorbing the OSINT / analytical layer. The signature deal is Mastercard's \$2.65B acquisition of Recorded Future, announced September 2024 and closed December 2024 — a payments network paying a premium for the category's most-cited OSINT brand.¹⁰ It is not alone. Bitsight acquired Cybersixgill (~\$115M, November 2024). And the front's largest independent, Dataminr, is itself acting as an acquirer: its \$290M acquisition of ThreatConnect, announced in October 2025, closed on 2025-11-25, extending Dataminr from real-time alerting into the fusion/analytics layer.³⁷³⁸ The logic is consistent: OSINT — the most accessible collection front — is being pulled up into adjacent platforms (payments, security ratings, alerting) that want its data and its analytical layer.

Engine two: private equity rolling up the collection and interception layer. Where strategic acquirers chase OSINT, PE chases the opaque, government-anchored collection assets. Thoma Bravo took Magnet Forensics private and combined it with Grayshift in a ~C\$1.8B transaction (2023), rolling up the tactical device-forensics layer. Haveli Investments took ZeroFox private (~\$350M, May 2024), and Spire Capital's PenLink absorbed Cobwebs (~\$200M, 2023). And in lawful interception, Mill Point Capital acquired SS8 Networks (2025), with Cy4Gate (the one public, Euronext-listed Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers issuer) having earlier absorbed the Aurora Group including RCS Lab (2022).¹¹³⁹⁴⁰¹²⁴¹ PE is doing to the collection layer what strategic acquirers are doing to OSINT — but privately, taking surveillance-adjacent assets off the public market and rolling them up.

Two strands run alongside. First, a **regulatory-restructuring** strand. Four public events line up here: Sandvine's 2024 Entity-List designation; its announced exit from 56 "non-democratic" countries (~45% of its 2023 revenue base, on its own disclosure); its removal from the list "following significant corporate reforms"; and its 2025 rebrand to AppLogic Networks.

Together they make the clearest public case of regulation, not the market, restructuring a collection vendor.⁴²⁴³⁴⁴⁴⁵ Second, a **fusion-accretion** strand: the analytical layer buying graph and entity-resolution capability — Nuix's up-to-€20M acquisition of Linkurious (signed December 2025, closed April 2026) and Elastic's strategic investment in Siren (December 2025).⁴⁶⁴⁷ Both strands point the same way as the two main engines: capability and capital accreting at and above the fusion layer, collection rolled up or constrained beneath it.

Pattern Claim 3 — Up-and-Out: Collection Consolidates, Analytics Gets Absorbed

The M&A in this market is not random dealmaking; it is the upward migration made visible. Strategic acquirers are absorbing the OSINT/analytical layer into adjacent platforms (Mastercard/Recorded Future, Bitsight/Cybersixgill). Private equity is rolling up the collection and interception layer off the public market (Thoma Bravo/Magnet-Grayshift, Mill Point/SS8, Haveli/ZeroFox, PenLink/Cobwebs). And the fusion layer is accreting graph and entity-resolution capability (Nuix/Linkurious, Elastic/Siren). All three vectors move value toward the analytical layer and roll up or constrain collection beneath it.

Falsifiable test. Suppose H2 2026 brings either (a) a further strategic-acquirer purchase of an OSINT or analytics pure-play by a non-defense platform, or (b) a further PE roll-up in the collection/interception layer. Then the up-and-out pattern hardens into the market's defining structure. The inverse would be the next major deals running the other way: a collection specialist acquiring an analytics platform as an independent, or a fresh named-lead primary equity round re-financing a standalone collector at an up valuation. That would weaken the pattern and show that independent collection is still financeable on its own. Primary signal: dated M&A announcements and funding rounds with named leads (vendor newsrooms, Reuters/Bloomberg/Calcalist, regulator press for export-control actions).

C.7 The Campaign Ahead — Cross-Front Watchlist for H2 2026

Five falsifiable signals, each spanning more than one front, will tell whether the convergence reading holds through the back half of 2026. Each grounds on a publicly observable event.

1. **A named agentic-outcome reference win (Fusion / Decision Intelligence + Open-Source Intelligence).** Signal: any vendor in fusion or OSINT publishes a named government or enterprise reference — or an independent time-to-insight benchmark — attributing a specific decision or outcome to autonomous agentic action. Threshold: one such named win and competitors silent → AI-native begins to separate into a real differentiator (Pattern Claim 2's first branch). Inverse: "agentic" stays uniform with no named-outcome win through Q4 2026 → demote to table stakes. Primary source: Dataminr, Babel Street, Strider, Cognyte, Palantir newsrooms; government reference-win coverage.
2. **A third strategic-acquirer absorption of an OSINT/analytics pure-play (Open-Source Intelligence → adjacent).** Signal: a payments, cloud, identity, security-ratings, or alerting acquirer buys a standalone OSINT/analytics collector. Threshold: one such deal in H2 2026 — or, with the Dataminr/ThreatConnect acquisition now closed, a further roll-up (or a Dataminr IPO pricing) → Pattern Claim 3's absorption engine hardens. Inverse: a fresh named-lead primary mega-round at an up valuation on a pure-play → independent collection is still financeable. Primary source: named-outlet M&A coverage; vendor press releases.
3. **A verified-suite move — a vendor publishing an integrated single-platform reference across collection and fusion (cross-front).** Signal: any vendor publishes a dated, named, single-platform reference that unifies three or more collection-and-fusion practices as one *verified* product. It would be one product, not a span of separate product pages, public filings, and trademarks. Threshold: one vendor crosses that line → Pattern Claim 1's "public-span-not-a-verified-suite" reading weakens toward a real integrated suite. Inverse: the broadest footprints stay spans of distinct public surfaces → the claim holds. Primary source: vendors' own product pages, single-platform reference architectures, and investor materials; analyst reclassification.
4. **An encryption-erosion or 5G-SA inflection (National Agencies + Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers + Tactical Intelligence).** Signal: a public demonstration of durable 5G-SA content interception at scale (which would relieve the National Agencies and Tactical Intelligence squeeze), or, conversely, accelerating 4G sunset and ECH/QUIC adoption

reported as breaking deployed interception. Threshold: either event named publicly → re-rank the technology-shift pressure on the three interception-and-collection fronts. Primary source: 3GPP/ETSI standards activity, vendor ETI product-page changes, named-outlet telecom coverage.

5. **A further export-control or accountability action (National Agencies + Tactical Intelligence).** Signal: a new Entity-List designation, EU Dual-Use enforcement, or sanctions action against a named collection or surveillance vendor – or a cured-and-restructured re-entry on the Sandvine model. Threshold: one named action → the regulatory-restructuring strand of Pattern Claim 3 extends and the legitimate gradeable set narrows further. Primary source: US BIS / Federal Register, EU DPA and dual-use enforcement press, Citizen Lab / Amnesty public analysis.

The throughline of all five signals is the same one the convergence opened on: value is migrating up the stack, the floor is rising under collection, and the contest in 2026 is for the analytical layer. Where a vendor sits relative to that migration – climbing toward fusion, defending a standards-gated niche, or stuck in commoditizing collection – is the single best public predictor of which side of this market's consolidation it will be on.

Sources & Notes

All sources are public: vendors' own dated product pages, public filings, and dated named-outlet reporting, carried over from the five front chapters this synthesis reconciles. Market-size figures are cited to their publishers and are never averaged. Capability is reported as public positioning ("markets itself as"), not as verified architecture.

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48. Cognyte, Network Intelligence glossary — National Agencies (mass-collection) primary pillar ("Network Intelligence refers to intelligence which is obtained from fixed, mobile, IP, cable and satellite communications networks ... the gathering and analysis of signals intelligence (SIGINT) data sources using machine learning and AI"). <https://www.cognyte.com/glossary/network-intelligence/> (accessed 2026-06-16). The "Network Intelligence = mass-scale collection" read is opinion-labeled, grounded in this glossary read against Cognyte's own VANTAGE trademark ("interception, collection, monitoring," USPTO Serial 78417244, assignee Cognyte Software Ltd.) and SEC Form 20-F (company origin in "lawful communications interception"); no specific Cognyte deployment is asserted as fact and no intent is attributed. Verint-era material (e.g., Slate, 2013-01-30) is framed strictly as inherited lineage from the February 2021 spinout, not a current Cognyte product. The 20-F business-description sentence is now **CONFIRMED verbatim** against Cognyte's filed SEC Form 20-F (FY2026, filed 2026-03-25, accession 0001824814-26-000021; the LI-origin clause recurs FY2021-FY2026), and the VANTAGE goods-description is **confirmed** verbatim against the USPTO record (owner Cognyte Software Ltd., Serial 78417244 / Reg. 3248122, REGISTERED AND RENEWED). Carried per the National Agencies chapter's Cognyte grade. ↩↩↩↩
49. Cognyte, NEXYTE for LEA / Investigation — Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers (lawful interception) primary pillar ("unifying agencies' data sources, including lawful interception, digital forensics, open sources and government databases"). <https://www.cognyte.com/nexyte/lea-investigation/> (accessed 2026-06-16). [URL pinned to the canonical LEA page — the same page the Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers chapter's [^{^c9}] directly fetched and verbatim-confirmed; distinct from the Fusion / Decision Intelligence national-security page at [^{^cv3}] / [^{^cv50}] -adjacent, so the same verbatim quote is not sourced to two different pages.] Graded Attention, not Gravity: no current standalone monitoring-centre product page and no public LI-certification claim — the gap is the finding. Corroboration only: 20-F LI-origin and the VANTAGE trademark; inherited Verint-era LI/monitoring-centre lineage framed strictly as inherited (Feb-2021 spinout), not a current product. The 20-F business-description sentence is now **CONFIRMED verbatim** against Cognyte's filed SEC Form 20-F (FY2026, filed 2026-03-25, accession 0001824814-26-000021; the LI-origin clause recurs FY2021-FY2026), and the VANTAGE goods-description is **confirmed** verbatim against the USPTO record (owner Cognyte Software Ltd., Serial 78417244 / Reg. 3248122, REGISTERED AND RENEWED). Carried per the Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers chapter's Cognyte grade. ↩↩↩
50. Cognyte, Border Protection — Tactical Intelligence (tactical) primary pillar ("Cognyte's Border Protection solution takes a multi-layered approach by analyzing existing border sensors ... and fusing together with SIGINT, OSINT and VISINT sources"). <https://www.cognyte.com/border-protection-maritime-intelligence-na/> (accessed 2026-06-16). Corroborated by a dated ~\$5M tactical-SIGINT military-intelligence deal (BusinessWire/StockTitan, 2025-11-19). Some tactical product names are classified/non-public, so the grade is built strictly from the public border-protection page + the dated deal. Carried per the Tactical Intelligence chapter's Cognyte grade. ↩↩↩↩

Disclosures

DISCLOSURE.

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